

YUYANG ZHAN

Phone: (+86) 18110632588 | Email: yyzhan@mit.edu | Website: yuyangzhan-econ.github.io

EDUCATION

DEGREE PROGRAMS

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)

Admitted; expected start 01/2027

Master of Applied Science in Data, Economics, and Design of Policy

Renmin University of China (RUC)

09/2022 - 06/2026

Bachelor of Economics, major in Labor Economics

GPA: 3.89/4.0, WES: 3.98 (ranked top 4% in cohort)

• **Related courses:**

Econ: Econometrics (100 in final exam), Intermediate Microeconomics (90+), Intermediate Macroeconomics (90+), Experimental and Behavioral Economics (90+), Game Theory, Public Economics (90+), Labor Economics I–II (90+), Poverty and Inequality (Development Economics, 90+), Advanced Microeconomics (Ph.D. Level, Audit), Advanced Econometrics (Ph.D. Level, Audit).

Math: Statistics (90+), Calculus I–II (Multivariable Calculus and ODE, 90), Probability Theory and Mathematical Statistics (90), Linear Algebra (90), Optimization Theory and Methodology (Spring 2026), Functional Analysis (Audit), Mathematical Modeling.

Programming: Machine Learning, Python Program Design, ArcGIS.

Psychology: Introduction to Psychology.

• **Teaching Assistant:** Intermediate Microeconomics (Fall 2025, Spring 2026).

• **Weekly Seminar Series Attended:** Empirical IO (Spring 2026), Trade (Fall 2025).

• **Thesis:** “Green Lands, Green Games: Strategic Land Supply and Booming Urban Greens in China” (selected as an outstanding undergraduate thesis).

NON-DEGREE PROGRAMS

MicroMasters Program in Data, Economics, and Design of Policy (MITx)

09/2024 - 12/2025

• Courses: Microeconomics (95), Data Analysis for Social Scientists (96), Designing and Running Randomized Evaluations (97), Foundations of Development Policy (98), Political Economy and Economic Development (93).

Oriel College, University of Oxford (International Summer Institute)

07/2024

• Courses: (3 credits) Microeconomics and Game Theory (91).

AWARDS AND HONORS

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| • Research and Innovation Scholarship (10,000 rmb, highest) | RUC with JD.com, Inc., 2025 |
| • International Exchange Scholarship (10,000 rmb, highest) | RUC, 2025 |
| • National Scholarship (10,000 rmb, highest) | Ministry of Education of PRC, 2024 |
| • Merit Student | RUC, 2023 - 2024 |
| • Excellent Scholarship | RUC, 2023 |

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Project: Bias in Ugandan Education System (Randomized Controlled Trial) **06/2025 - Present**

Research Assistant, with Prof. Yihong Huang (Peking University), Yuen Ho (Trinity College Dublin)

- Assisted in designing and implementing a randomized experiment **examining gender bias in Uganda’s education system** using behavioral economics frameworks.
- Developed and programmed **Implicit Association Test** (IAT) using `iatgen` in **R** and **SurveyCTO** form definitions.

Project: Green Lands, Green Games: Strategic Land Supply and Booming Urban Greens in China

Independent Research

02/2025 - Present

- Built a city–distance–ring–year panel from over **1 million** land-transaction records and air-quality monitor locations in China to study strategic land supply around environmental monitoring stations.
- Estimated difference-in-differences and event-study specifications in **Stata**, with data cleaning and geospatial matching implemented in **Python** and **ArcGIS**.
- Developed a simple urban-economics model based on the monocentric city framework to rationalize local governments’ land-allocation responses to environmental monitoring incentives.
- Draft available upon request; prepared as a writing sample.

Project: Employment Monitoring and Policy Simulation**04/2024 - 12/2024***Research Assistant, with Prof. Liqiu Zhao, Xiong Xiao et al.**(Affiliation: Bigdata and Responsible Artificial Intelligence for National Government, RUC)*

- Designed and developed agent-based large language models (LLMs) to simulate the behavior of employees and employers in China's labor market, with a focus on analyzing their responses to policy shocks.
- Conducted descriptive statistics on China's labor market using **Stata** based on the 2015 mini-census dataset.
- Collaborated with Ph.D. researchers to apply economic-model-based prompt engineering for advanced analytics.

Project: Can Low-carbon Transition Impact Labor Migration? Empirical Evidence from Low-carbon City Pilot*First Author, Group Leader***11/2023 - 03/2024**

- Investigated the impact of China's Low-carbon City Pilot on labor mobility using prefecture-level panel data from 286 cities, 2007–2019.
- Estimated **staggered difference-in-differences** specifications in **Stata** and contributed to the development of the empirical and theoretical framework.
- Won the first-prize award (**top 10%**) in the 26th “Innovation Cup” Student Extracurricular Academic Technology Works Competition.

Project: the Equalization of Education in Beijing**10/2023 - 12/2023***Research Assistant, with Prof. Liqiu Zhao*

RUC

- Examined the evolution of educational equality in Beijing over the past few decades and provided policy insights for the local government.
- Used **Python** and **web-scraping scripts** to collect and organize data and utilized **ArcGIS** for data visualization and **Stata** to derive descriptive statistics, mapping the development of primary and secondary education of different districts of Beijing over the past twenty years.

Hua'an Futures Co., LTD**07/2023 - 08/2023***Researcher, Futures Research Institute*

Hefei, China

- Analyzed USDA data and industry cases on agricultural products; findings informed the institute's corn-futures strategy research.

Field Study: “Qianrenbaicun” Social Survey Project**08/2023***Enumerator*

Miaohoucun Village, Anhui Province

- Conducted field research in a low-income rural village (*Miaohoucun*), collecting information on income, infrastructure, health care, education, and livelihood conditions.
- Findings were covered by local media (link: *anhuinews*), raising awareness of the village's social and economic situation.

CAMPUS EXPERIENCE/LEADERSHIP

Ruichen Academic Society of RUC**09/2025 - Present***Mentor*

RUC

- Mentored RUC lower-year undergraduate economics and finance students interested in research careers, with a focus on PhD and predoctoral RA applications, long-term academic planning, and academic development.
- Organized academic seminars for graduate and undergraduate students.

SKILLS/HOBBIES

Programming Languages and Tools**Language****General interests**Stata, Python, L^AT_EX, SurveyCTO, ArcGIS, R, C# (basic), Matlab (basic)
Chinese (native), English (fluent)

Piano and classical music, painting, sports (badminton, running, swimming, basketball, pickleball), video editing